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CONTACT ONE-SHEET · BENTLEY SYSTEMS · SEPTEMBER 15, 2026

Nicholas Cumins

Chief Executive Officer

\$1.5B (FY2025)

Revenue

Exton

HQ

01 Who You're Meeting

Nicholas Cumins — Chief Executive Officer, Bentley Systems.

In role: CEO since 1 July 2024 — the first non-family CEO in the company's 40-year history

Today: Leads Bentley Systems, the infrastructure engineering software company behind MicroStation, ProjectWise and Synchro, with AI-powered infrastructure digital twins as the strategic centre of gravity.

A product executive rather than an engineer or a founder, and his appointment marked a deliberate generational shift. He joined Bentley as Chief Product Officer in September 2020, shortly before the IPO, became COO in January 2022 and CEO in July 2024 under a transition plan announced that March. Before Bentley he was General Manager of SAP Marketing Cloud, Chief Product Officer of Scytel — an online voting platform — and SVP of Product at OpenX, a programmatic advertising pioneer, having earlier held senior SAP roles across product management, corporate strategy and business development.

Career: Chief Executive Officer, Bentley Systems; Chief Operating Officer, Bentley Systems; Chief Product Officer, Bentley Systems; General Manager, SAP Marketing Cloud, SAP Customer Experience

Education: Master's, Law, Paris-Panthéon-Assas University; Master's, Business & IT, Paris-Panthéon-Assas University

The company: Profitable, public infrastructure-software incumbent with a 40-year design-through-operations footprint — the closest thing to an "establishment" peer for Sand's water/energy/transport verticals, and the best-rated employer on this list by its own staff.

What they sell: iTwin Platform (infrastructure digital twins), AssetWise (asset/network performance), ProjectWise (project delivery), SYNCHRO (construction management) and MicroStation-based design tools; 41,000+ accounts in ~195 countries.

02 Where The Company Sits

Strong overlap with Sand on infrastructure asset lifecycle and digital twins, but Bentley's roots are in engineering design software (CAD-first) rather than real-time operational AI control.

03 Talking Points

- Bentley's asset coverage — roads, bridges, dams, water networks, telecoms towers — maps onto infrastructure portfolios more directly than any other vendor tracked here.
- A product background from SAP and adtech, so roadmap and platform questions will land better than procurement ones.
- First non-family CEO after 40 years: worth understanding what he is changing and what the executive chair still holds.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- AI narrative is "emerging," not core — lags Palantir/C3.ai/Cognite on generative and agentic AI maturity
- Dual-class share structure keeps the founding family in control, limiting activist or outside investor influence
- CAD/engineering-design heritage means real-time operational AI control is a newer, less-proven muscle than for Sand or Cognite

04 GIP Context

GIP: No named GIP portfolio company was confirmed as a Bentley customer, though Bentley's customer base of government transportation agencies and infrastructure owner-operators plausibly overlaps with GIP-owned airports, ports and rail (Bentley's software is near-ubiquitous in civil infrastructure engineering)

BlackRock: Confirmed — 5.4% of shares outstanding per a July 2026 Schedule 13G/A, making BlackRock Bentley's largest institutional holder outside the founding Bentley family, which retains majority voting control via dual-class shares.

Others at Bentley Systems: Greg Bentley (Executive Chairman (co-founder))

www.bentley.com · [Appointment announcement](#) · [Investor relations release](#) · [ENR interview on the transition](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

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